

DOCUMENT 41

THE FIRST \$1 MILLION

90-DAY SPONSORSHIP PIPELINE & EXECUTION PLAN

A focused operating plan to build the qualified pipeline, executive conversations and closing discipline required to pursue \$1,000,000 in cash sponsorships in 90 days

Mission: Build a professional, measurable sponsorship operation around the Student Impact Challenge. This document is a planning framework - not a guarantee of fundraising results. The \$1 million objective requires strong program credibility, sponsor fit, decision-maker access, disciplined follow-up, leadership involvement and favorable corporate budget timing.

\$1,000,000 CASH GOAL | \$6,000,000 QUALIFIED PIPELINE GOAL | 90 DAYS

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Do not try to raise \$1 million by treating 1,000 companies equally. Concentrate leadership time on organizations capable of making meaningful \$50,000-\$250,000 decisions, while fellows create enough qualified conversations to keep the pipeline full. Smaller sponsorships remain valuable, but they should not consume the majority of senior closing capacity.

1. THE \$1 MILLION CLOSING ARCHITECTURE

Sponsor Level	Target Wins	Planning Avg.	Cash Target	Typical Ask Range
Flagship / Transformational	2	\$150,000	\$300,000	\$100K-\$250K+
Major	4	\$75,000	\$300,000	\$50K-\$100K
Leadership	6	\$40,000	\$240,000	\$25K-\$50K
Supporting	8	\$20,000	\$160,000	\$10K-\$25K
TOTAL	20	\$50,000 avg.	\$1,000,000	

This is one possible closing mix. The actual mix can differ substantially. A single \$250,000 flagship partnership can replace several smaller wins; conversely, a portfolio of \$10,000-\$50,000 sponsors can still reach the goal but requires more transactions.

2. PIPELINE FUNNEL - MANAGE THIS EVERY DAY

Stage	90-Day Target	Definition
\$6.0M Qualified Pipeline	\$6,000,000	Real fit + plausible decision-maker + relevant ask + active next action. Not merely a name on a list.
\$3.0M Proposal / Defined Ask	\$3,000,000	Prospect has engaged enough for a defined proposal, sponsorship menu or formal ask.
\$1.5M Approval / Late Stage	\$1,500,000	Specific support is being evaluated, negotiated or moved through approval/procurement.
\$1.0M Closed Cash	\$1,000,000	Meets the program's confirmed sponsorship standard; track received cash separately.

Important: Theoretical ask capacity is not qualified pipeline. A \$150,000 ask assigned to a company that has never engaged is still a prospecting hypothesis.

3. WHO WE GO AFTER WITH THIS FIREPOWER

The first 90 days should prioritize sectors where the Student Impact Challenge can credibly connect to youth opportunity, education, entrepreneurship, workforce readiness, STEM/AI, financial literacy, community investment, scholarships, teacher recognition or real-world problem solving.

Priority Sector	Why It Can Fit	Primary Cash Ask	Secondary / In-Kind Path
Banks & Financial Services	Financial literacy, economic mobility, entrepreneurship, youth leadership	\$50K-\$250K	Financial education, scholarships, mentors
Technology / AI / Cloud	AI literacy, STEM, digital skills, innovation, future workforce	\$50K-\$250K+	Devices, software, cloud credits, mentors
Telecom / Connectivity	Digital inclusion, student technology access, future-ready skills	\$50K-\$150K	Connectivity, devices, STEM experiences
Insurance / Financial Protection	Financial resilience, careers, community investment	\$25K-\$150K	Financial education, career speakers
Healthcare / Health Systems	Community health, youth careers, local impact	\$25K-\$100K	Career exposure, wellness education
Consumer Brands / Food / CPG	Families, community visibility, product relevance	\$25K-\$100K	Products, prizes, food, gift cards
National Retailers	Youth development, workforce, local communities	\$25K-\$100K	Gift cards, products, local activations
Airlines / Travel / Hospitality	Career exposure, teacher/winner recognition, travel experiences	\$25K-\$100K	Airfare, hotel/resort packages
Media / Entertainment	Youth voice, storytelling, community awareness	\$25K-\$100K	Advertising inventory, production support
Automotive / Mobility	STEM, engineering, careers, community mobility	\$25K-\$100K	Experiences, transportation, prizes
Professional Services	Entrepreneurship, careers, business skills, mentorship	\$25K-\$100K	Mentors, workshops, pro bono expertise
Utilities / Energy / Sustainability	STEM, environment, community resilience	\$25K-\$100K	Education, site visits, sustainability activations
Foundations / Corporate Foundations	Youth opportunity, education, workforce, communities	\$25K-\$250K+	Program grants; multi-year pathway
Universities / Education	Scholarships, access, career pathways, student recruitment	\$10K-\$100K	Scholarships, campus experiences, mentors
Sports / Major Venues	Youth inspiration, community engagement, experiences	\$10K-\$75K	Tickets, experiences, athlete/community engagement

4. HIGH-PRIORITY EXAMPLES TO RESEARCH FIRST

These are prospect examples, not claims that any organization will sponsor the program. Each must be researched for the correct current program, geography, eligibility, budget cycle and decision-maker before outreach.

Category	Prospect Examples
Banking / Finance	JPMorganChase; Bank of America; Capital One; Citi; American Express; Mastercard; Visa; Morgan Stanley; Goldman Sachs; Synchrony; TD Bank; M&T; Bank
Technology / AI	Google / Google.org; Microsoft; IBM; Amazon / AWS; Salesforce; Adobe; Dell Technologies; HP; Lenovo; Cisco; Intel; NVIDIA; Samsung; LG
Telecom	Verizon; T-Mobile; AT&T; Comcast / NBCUniversal
Insurance	MetLife / MetLife Foundation; New York Life; Guardian; Prudential; State Farm; Allstate; Nationwide; Liberty Mutual; Travelers
Retail / Consumer	Target; Walmart; CVS Health; Walgreens; Macy's; Costco; PepsiCo; Coca-Cola; Mondelez; Unilever; Procter & Gamble; Colgate-Palmolive
Healthcare	Northwell Health; NYU Langone Health; Mount Sinai; NewYork-Presbyterian; CVS Health; UnitedHealth Group; Elevance Health
Travel / Hospitality	Delta Air Lines; JetBlue; United Airlines; American Airlines; Marriott; Hilton; Hyatt; major all-inclusive resort groups
Media / Entertainment	Disney; Paramount; NBCUniversal; Warner Bros. Discovery; Sony; Netflix; Spotify; SiriusXM; major New York media organizations
Professional Services	Deloitte; PwC; EY; KPMG; Accenture; McKinsey; BCG; major law firms with community programs
Mobility / Auto	Toyota; Ford; General Motors; Hyundai; Kia; Honda; BMW; Mercedes-Benz; Uber; Lyft
Energy / Infrastructure	Con Edison; National Grid; major engineering, construction and infrastructure companies serving New York
Education / Sports	CUNY institutions; SUNY institutions; private universities; professional sports teams and foundations; major arenas/venues

5. WHY SOME PROSPECTS DESERVE IMMEDIATE ATTENTION

Current public evidence shows several organizations already operating in areas that overlap with the Challenge's positioning. This does **not** mean funding is available to this program; it means the alignment is strong enough to justify serious research and outreach.

Prospect	Current Public Signal	Possible Fit
JPMorganChase	In 2026 it announced expanded financial-health education and K-12 personal-finance efforts, and separately highlighted workforce-skills partnerships in New York City.	Financial literacy + youth opportunity + NYC workforce
Google.org	Current focus includes AI literacy, technology-enabled learning and career/workforce readiness; its U.S. AI Opportunity Fund supports education/workforce organizations.	AI + education + workforce readiness
Microsoft	Microsoft Elevate / Microsoft for Nonprofits emphasizes economic opportunity, digital inclusion, educational access, AI skills and the workforce of the future.	AI + nonprofit capacity + student/educator skills
IBM	Its 2026 Impact Accelerator RFP focused on AI-driven solutions for transformative education and workforce development.	AI + education + workforce
Verizon	Verizon Innovative Learning focuses on digital inclusion, student/educator technology and digital skills; Verizon states a goal of providing digital-skills training to 10M youth by 2030.	Digital inclusion + STEM + youth
MetLife Foundation	In 2026 it announced more than \$6.5M in Community Impact Grants supporting essential community needs and resilience.	Community impact + resilience
Delta Air Lines	Its community engagement work includes partnerships with 100+ educational organizations and workforce-readiness/financial-literacy experiences.	Education + careers + experiential learning
Bank of America	Its Student Leaders program centers on youth employment, leadership, service and economic mobility; grant cycles have specific eligibility/timing rules.	Youth leadership + economic mobility
Target	Its 2026 Community Engagement Funds include youth development, workforce development and localized giving, though stated grants are generally \$1K-\$15K.	Local community layer, not flagship ask

6. TOP 100 MUST-PURSUE MODEL

Do not choose the Top 100 simply because the companies are famous. Score each prospect and rank it. The Top 100 should be the organizations where **capacity + program alignment + New York relevance + funding behavior + access + timing** create the best probability-adjusted opportunity.

Factor	Weight	Question
Financial Capacity	20	Can this organization plausibly make a \$50K-\$250K decision?
Mission / Program Alignment	20	Does the Challenge directly connect to current priorities?
Youth / Education / Workforce Fit	15	Is student opportunity a demonstrated priority?
New York Relevance	10	Does it have a meaningful NY presence, workforce, customers or community strategy?
Funding / Sponsorship Behavior	10	Does it actively fund or partner with nonprofits/education/community programs?
Decision-Maker Accessibility	10	Can we identify a legitimate pathway to the right team?
90-Day Timing	10	Is there a realistic current budget/application/partnership window?
Activation Potential	5	Can it contribute experiences, mentors, products or visibility beyond cash?

Tiering: 85-100 = Tier A / executive priority; 70-84 = Tier B / strong pursuit; 55-69 = Tier C / fellow-led development; below 55 = nurture or deprioritize.

7. THEORETICAL TARGET UNIVERSE - THEN QUALIFY HARD

Tier	Targets	Planning Ask	Theoretical Ask Capacity	Operating Rule
A	60	\$150K	\$9.0M	Founder/leadership attention; warm intros and executive outreach.
B	125	\$75K	\$9.375M	Senior fellow + leadership support; customized outreach.
C	250	\$35K	\$8.75M	Fellow-led qualification; escalate strong engagement.
D	400	\$12.5K	\$5.0M	Volume/community layer; do not distract senior closers.
TOTAL	835	-	\$32.125M	Only a fraction should become qualified pipeline.

8. 90-DAY EXECUTION CALENDAR

Period	Primary Mission	Required Outputs	Leadership Focus
Days 1-10	Rank & Prepare	Top 100 ranked; next 300 prioritized; decision-maker research; asks assigned; outreach assets ready	Founder introductions, flagship narrative, Tier A review
Days 11-30	Create Conversations	Heavy personalized outreach, calls, referrals, LinkedIn, meetings; clean CRM	Executive outreach to Tier A; join high-value first meetings
Days 31-45	Qualify Aggressively	Budget, priorities, decision process, timing, ask size, proposal requirements	Turn interest into defined opportunities
Days 46-60	Build Proposal Pipeline	Customized proposals, sponsorship options, executive meetings, follow-up	Own \$50K+ proposal strategy; remove stalled fantasy pipeline
Days 61-75	Close / Approval	Procurement, agreements, internal approvals, revisions, invoice/donation process	Direct closing involvement on major opportunities
Days 76-90	Final Push + Expansion	Close late-stage deals; expand strong partners; activate backup targets; secure next-step dates	Daily late-stage review; unblock decisions; protect relationships

9. WEEKLY CASH-PIPELINE MILESTONES

Checkpoint	Qualified Pipeline	Proposal / Defined Ask	Late Stage	Closed Cash
End Week 2	\$750K-\$1.0M	\$100K-\$250K	-	-
End Week 4	\$1.5M-\$2.0M	\$500K-\$750K	\$100K-\$250K	Early wins possible
End Week 6	\$2.5M-\$3.5M	\$1.0M-\$1.5M	\$300K-\$500K	\$100K-\$250K
End Week 8	\$4.0M-\$5.0M	\$2.0M-\$2.5M	\$750K-\$1.0M	\$250K-\$500K
End Week 10	\$5.0M-\$6.0M	\$2.5M-\$3.0M	\$1.0M-\$1.5M	\$500K-\$750K
Day 90	Maintain \$6M+	\$3M+ cumulative	Enough to replenish closes	\$1.0M objective

These milestones are management targets, not forecasts. If actual conversion differs, adjust prospect volume, ask mix, outreach quality and leadership involvement rather than manipulating stage definitions.

10. DAILY WAR-ROOM DASHBOARD

Metric	Today	This Week	90-Day Target
New qualified Tier A/B opportunities	_____	_____	Track
Decision-makers reached	_____	_____	Track
Positive corporate responses	_____	_____	Track
Meetings booked / held	_____ / _____	_____ / _____	Track
New qualified cash pipeline	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$6.0M
New proposals / defined asks	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$3.0M
Late-stage / approval	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$1.5M+
Closed cash	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$1.0M
Confirmed in-kind	\$ _____	\$ _____	Separate scoreboard

11. WHO OWNS WHAT

Role	Primary Responsibility
Student Fellows	Research, qualification, contact discovery, personalized outreach, follow-up, CRM, meeting preparation, proposal inputs.
Senior Fellow / Manager	Quality control, pipeline review, coaching, duplicate prevention, priority assignment, escalation.
Founder / Leadership	Flagship narrative, warm introductions, executive meetings, major asks, negotiation, unapproved benefits, major proposals and closes.
Operations / Finance	Agreements, invoices/donation documentation, payment tracking, in-kind controls and sponsor onboarding.
Program / Communications	Approved program facts, activation feasibility, benefits, branding, fulfillment and impact reporting.

12. EXECUTIVE ESCALATION RULES

- Any prospect discussing \$50,000+ should be reviewed for leadership involvement.
- \$100,000+ opportunities should normally have a founder/executive strategy before proposal delivery.
- Requests for exclusivity, naming rights, participant data, major media commitments, celebrity access, legal terms or unusual benefits must be escalated.
- A fellow should not allow a high-value prospect to sit unanswered because the correct response is uncertain - escalate quickly.
- Warm introductions from board members, executives, elected/community leaders, alumni, customers or existing partners should be treated as high-value assets and coordinated carefully.

13. CASH FIRST - IN-KIND SEPARATE

The 90-day mission is \$1,000,000 in cash sponsorships. Scholarships, laptops, airfare, hotel stays, media inventory, tickets, products, professional services and other donated value can be extremely important, but they must sit on a separate scoreboard so the team never mistakes \$1 million of mixed value for \$1 million of cash.

14. WHAT NOT TO DO

- Do not send the same generic sponsorship email to 5,000 companies.
- Do not let fellows spend days chasing organizations that can only make \$1,000 decisions while major opportunities go untouched.
- Do not treat famous companies as automatically high-priority if there is no program fit or decision pathway.
- Do not inflate pipeline by assigning large asks to silent prospects.
- Do not count grants with closed application windows as 90-day cash opportunities unless another legitimate pathway exists.
- Do not promise sponsor benefits before confirming program capacity and leadership approval.
- Do not wait until Day 75 to involve leadership in a \$100K opportunity.
- Do not abandon smaller sponsors; route them into a lower-cost, fellow-led track.

15. THE FIRST 10-DAY SPRINT

Day	Action
Day 1	Freeze list expansion; consolidate all existing prospect lists.
Day 2	Deduplicate companies; separate cash prospects from primarily in-kind prospects.
Day 3	Score the strongest 200 using the Top 100 model.
Day 4	Finalize Top 100; assign Tier A/B/C/D.
Day 5	Assign a primary and secondary ask to every Top 100 prospect.
Day 6	Identify decision-maker departments and legitimate contact paths.
Day 7	Map warm introductions and relationship paths.
Day 8	Prepare 5-7 category-specific outreach narratives and supporting materials.
Day 9	Leadership reviews Top 25 flagship/major targets and opening strategy.
Day 10	Launch coordinated outreach; every prospect has an owner and next date.

16. FIRST 25 EXECUTIVE-LEVEL PROSPECT PROFILE

The actual Top 25 should be selected after scoring. As a starting research universe, prioritize a mix such as:

Cluster	Starting Research Universe
Financial / Economic Mobility	JPMorganChase; Bank of America; Capital One; Citi; American Express; Mastercard
Technology / AI	Google / Google.org; Microsoft; IBM; Amazon / AWS; Salesforce; NVIDIA
Connectivity	Verizon; T-Mobile
Insurance / Community	MetLife / MetLife Foundation; New York Life
Consumer / Retail	PepsiCo; Target; Walmart
Travel / Experience	Delta Air Lines; JetBlue
Professional / Workforce	Accenture; Deloitte
Healthcare / NY Presence	Northwell Health

This list intentionally mixes organizations with different sponsorship/grant mechanisms. Some may have closed application windows, invitation-only processes or longer budget cycles. The research team must determine the correct pathway before treating any prospect as a 90-day opportunity.

17. CONVERSION DIAGNOSTICS - KNOW WHAT IS BROKEN

Problem	Likely Cause	Management Response
Lots of outreach, few replies	Weak targeting, wrong contacts, generic message, poor credibility	Audit 20 messages; improve contact fit and opening proposition.
Replies, few meetings	Ask unclear or program story not compelling enough	Strengthen CTA; use shorter materials; add leadership selectively.
Meetings, few proposals	Poor discovery, weak fit or no budget/timing	Qualify harder; ask budget/process questions; remove weak opportunities.
Proposals, few closes	Ask/benefits/timing misaligned; insufficient executive involvement	Review proposal strategy; leadership follow-up; create alternatives.
Pipeline huge, cash tiny	Pipeline definitions inflated	Re-stage every opportunity using evidence; remove silent prospects.
Too much in-kind, little cash	Team defaulting to easier non-cash asks	Make cash the primary ask for capable prospects; in-kind as secondary where appropriate.

18. SOURCE SIGNALS USED FOR THIS PLAN

Current official public materials reviewed in August 2026 include: JPMorganChase's 2026 community banking/financial-health expansion and NYC workforce story; Google.org's Knowledge, Skills & Learning and AI Opportunity Fund materials; Microsoft for Nonprofits / Microsoft Elevate materials; IBM's 2026 Impact Accelerator education/workforce RFP; Verizon Innovative Learning; MetLife Foundation's 2026 Community Impact Grants; Delta's education/community engagement materials; Bank of America's Student Leaders and 2026 grant-cycle guidance; and Target's 2026 Community Engagement Funds. These sources support prospect prioritization signals only - they do not establish sponsorship availability for the Student Impact Challenge.

19. 90-DAY LEADERSHIP COMMANDMENT

The first \$1 million will not come from having the longest sponsor list. It will come from identifying the strongest opportunities, reaching the right people, making appropriately ambitious asks, following up professionally, bringing leadership into the right conversations and refusing to confuse activity with progress.

90-DAY SCOREBOARD

Cash Goal: \$1,000,000 | Qualified Pipeline: \$6,000,000 | Proposal Pipeline: \$3,000,000 | Late Stage: \$1,500,000+

PROGRAM CONTACT

Frantz Coutard

Founder, Student Impact Challenge

Founder & President, TrendCatch Gives Back Inc.

Email: Info@frantzcoutard.com

Cell: 516-697-6962

Website: FrantzCoutard.com